

List of Things to Kill Time, a.k.a, the "Weekend List"

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Chill

- Play Cuphead
- Death March
- Driving/Teach Driving
- Tennis

Dallas

- Opera/Symphony
- Plano Farmstead Museum

Lafayette

- Samara House
- Colombian Park zoo
- Haan Museum
- Fort Ouitatenon
- Morris Schoolhouse

Books

- Madame Bovary
- The Adventures of Huckleberry Finn
- Atlas Shrugged
- Catch-22
- Cat's Cradle
- Gone With the Wind
- The Good Earth
- The Sirens of Titan
- God Bless You, Mr. Rosewater
- ~~God Bless You, Dr. Kevorkian~~
- A Man without A Country
- ~~Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy~~
- Flowers for Algernon
- The Count of Monte Cristo (in French?)
- Les Miserable (in French)
- The Grapes of Wrath
- Things My Son Needs to Know about the World
- Writing for Computer Science
- Komi Can't Communicate
- Leatherheads
- ~~Invincible~~

Movies

- Naked Gun 2½
- ~~Man from Earth~~
- ~~Cunk on Life~~
- Train to Busan
- ~~Exorcist~~
- Riverdance and the Book of Mormon (Not released as movie, but as a musical)
- Austin Powers
- ~~Attack on Titan - The Last Stand~~
- ~~Mandela~~

- American Hustle
- ~~Borat~~
- ~~Bruno~~
- ~~Dead Poet's Society~~
- ~~The Breakfast Club~~
- The Shawshank Redemption
- Amistad
- The Green Mile
- District 9
- The Mission
- The Elephant Man
- ~~Grave of the Fireflies~~
- The Shape of Water
- Cinema Paradiso
- The Godfather
- The Irishman
- Casablanca
- The Fault in Our Stars
- Fiddler on the Roof
- Porgy and Bess

TV

- The Sopranos
- Arcane

Food to Cook

- Mars Bar and Apple Sandwich
- Marzipan
- Marzipanbrot
- ~~Pizza~~
- ~~Boba~~
- ~~Artisan Bread~~
- ~~Paneer Piccata~~
- Egg Banh Mi
- Paneer Banh Mi
- Beet Gnocchi w/ Pine Nut, Goat Cheese, Fava Bean, Apple, Basil
- ~~Tortellini Salad~~
- Panuozzo Napolitano
- Ice Cream (from scratch)
 - Soursop
 - Nutella + Specloos
- ~~Challah~~
- ~~Feta Cheese~~
- Pretzels
- Bagels
- ~~Bourekas w/ Farmer Cheese/Paneer~~
- Falafel
- ~~Paneer Caprese Wraps~~
- ~~Farmer's Cheese~~
- Frittata
- Focaccia
- ~~Horiatiki~~
- Avoglemono
- Spanakopita

- Portokalopita
- Assyrian Pomegranate Cake
- ~~Coffee Jelly~~
- Cannelloni
- Eggplant Parmigiana
- Taco with Mushroom, Goat Cheese, Red Pickled Onion
- Pesto
- Cannoli
- Chaffles
- Doughnuts
- Tempeh
- Seitan
- Risotto
- ~~Fasolada~~
- Sweet Tea
- Grisi Torinesi
- Whipped Ricotta
- Melanzane Pizza
- Pesto
- Caprese Salad
- Lemon Cake
- Level 10 Chocolate Chip Cookie
- Meet Fresh
- Lemonade
- Candied Citrus Peels
- Golden Berries
- Yuzu

Music to Listen To

- Porgy and Bess

Restaurants to Try

- Never Ending Pasta Bowl (Olive Garden)
- ~~CAVA~~
- ~~Little Caesar's Pizza~~
- Portillo's
- ~~Campisi's~~
- ~~Blaze Pizza~~
- ~~Rosa's Cafe~~
- Waffle House
- ~~Sbarro~~
- ~~Swig~~
- Firehouse Subs
- P-Terry
- ~~Burger King~~
- Chico's Tacos
- ~~CCCP Market~~
- Handel's Ice Cream
- ~~Manoli's~~
- Shake Shack Mushroom Burger
- Silver Dipper
- Knight Spot
- West Side Scoops
- Coldstone

- Jeni's
- Pink Walrus
- Budges
- Peach Cobbler Factory
- Miss Sugar

Multicourse Meals

Recipes

Sweet iced tea

Serves 4

Ingredients

- 4 black tea bags (e.g. Lipton)
- 2 cups boiling water
- 4 cups cold water
- ½ cup sugar
- ½ lemon, sliced (optional)

Method

1. Steep tea bags in boiling water for 5 minutes. Don't over-steep.
 2. Remove bags. Stir in sugar until dissolved.
 3. Add cold water. Refrigerate at least 2 hours. Serve over ice.
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Grissini torinesi

Serves 4 · 24 breadsticks

Ingredients

- 250 g bread flour or 00 flour
- 160 ml warm water
- 1 tsp instant yeast
- 1 tsp salt
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 2 tbsp sesame seeds or rosemary (optional)

Method

1. Combine flour, yeast, salt. Add water and olive oil. Knead 8 minutes until smooth.
 2. Cover, rest 1 hour until puffy.
 3. Preheat oven to 400°F (200°C). Line two baking sheets with parchment.
 4. Divide dough into 24 pieces. Roll each into a thin rope, 10–12 inches long. Sprinkle with sesame or rosemary if using.
 5. Bake 18–22 minutes until golden and fully crisp, rotating halfway. Cool completely on a rack.
Underbaked grissini go soft quickly — when in doubt, give them 3 more minutes.
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Whipped ricotta

Serves 4

Ingredients

- 250 g whole-milk ricotta
- 60 g cream cheese

- 1 lemon, zested
- 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- ½ tsp salt
- 1 tsp fresh thyme or black pepper to finish

Method

1. Whip ricotta, cream cheese, lemon juice, and salt in a food processor or stand mixer for 2 minutes until smooth and airy.
2. Transfer to a bowl. Drizzle with olive oil, top with lemon zest and thyme or pepper.

Refrigerate until serving.

Make at least 1 hour ahead.

Caprese salad with arugula

Serves 4

Ingredients

- 400 g fresh mozzarella, pre-sliced
- 4 ripe tomatoes (heirloom if possible), sliced
- 60 g arugula
- 20 fresh basil leaves
- 3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tsp flaky salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 tbsp balsamic glaze (optional)

Method

1. Spread arugula across the platter as the base.
2. Alternate mozzarella and tomato slices over arugula. Tuck basil between slices.
3. Right before serving, drizzle with olive oil. Season with flaky salt and pepper. Add balsamic glaze if using.

Don't dress ahead — tomatoes weep and arugula wilts.

Melanzane pizza with pesto

Serves 4

Dough (from your meal prep recipe)

- 630 g bread flour
- 15 g sugar
- 10 g kosher salt
- 10 g instant yeast
- 32 g oil
- 420 g lukewarm water

Makes 8 portions (142 g each). Freeze individually; thaw in fridge overnight before use. Use 1 portion per pizza.

Toppings (per pizza)

- 1 eggplant (melanzane), sliced into ¼-inch rounds
- 1 tsp salt (for sweating)
- 2 tbsp olive oil (for roasting)
- 150 g fresh mozzarella, torn
- 30 g parmesan, grated

- 4 tbsp store-bought pesto

Method

1. **Night before:** Combine all dry dough ingredients. Add oil and water, mix until shaggy. Knead until dough passes the windowpane test (10 min by hand). Divide into 8 balls (142 g each), place in oiled containers, ferment in fridge 24–72 hours. Freeze unused portions.
2. **Day-of:** Lay eggplant in a single layer, sprinkle with salt, rest 30 minutes. Pat completely dry.
3. Brush slices with olive oil. Roast at 425°F (220°C) for 20–25 min, flipping halfway.
4. Place pizza stone or steel on top rack. Preheat oven to maximum (500–550°F) for at least 45 minutes.
5. Pull dough 1 hour before baking. Stretch by hand to a 12-inch round — no rolling pin.
6. Transfer to floured peel or parchment. Top with mozzarella, parmesan, then eggplant. Bake 8–10 minutes until blistered and charred in spots.
7. Remove from oven. Spoon pesto over immediately. Slice and serve.

Pesto goes on after baking — heat destroys basil.

Brown butter biscoff ice cream

Serves 4 · Make the day before

Ingredients

- 60 g unsalted butter
- 480 ml heavy cream
- 120 ml whole milk
- 4 egg yolks
- 100 g sugar
- 4 tbsp Biscoff spread (cookie butter)
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ½ tsp salt
- 4 Biscoff cookies, crushed (optional topping)

Method

1. Brown butter in a light-colored pan over medium heat until amber and nutty, 5 min. Pour into a bowl to stop cooking.
2. Heat milk and half the cream until steaming. Whisk yolks and sugar. Slowly pour hot cream into yolks while whisking. Return to pan, stir over medium-low until it coats a spoon (170°F / 77°C).
3. Off heat, stir in browned butter, Biscoff spread, vanilla, and salt. Strain through a fine mesh sieve.
4. Stir in remaining cream. Refrigerate at least 4 hours or overnight.
5. Churn in ice cream maker 25 minutes until thick and creamy.
6. Transfer to container. Fold in crushed cookies if using. Freeze at least 6 hours until firm.

No ice cream maker? Freeze in a shallow dish and stir vigorously every 30 minutes for 3 hours.

Lemon Cake

Special Equipment

- 1 8" springform pan
- 1 cake tester optional
- 1 brush optional

Ingredients

Cake:

- 3 eggs
- 300 g sugar
- 275 g all purpose flour
- 2 ½ tsp baking powder or 1 packet Italian Pane Degli Angeli vanilla baking powder
- 100 g butter softened
- 100 g Greek yogurt plain
- 300 g Meyer lemon organic, washed and cut into pieces (with the rind, but remove the seeds)
- ½ tsp vanilla extract ONLY if using plain baking powder

Glaze:

- 30 ml lemon juice
- 30 ml water
- 35 g sugar (a little less than 3 Tbsp)

Instructions

- Preheat oven to 350°F (175°C).
- Prepare an 8" springform pan by spraying with oil (or butter) and lining in parchment paper (sides optional, if you want really clean sides), then spray the paper, too.
- Place the sugar and eggs in a large bowl and beat with a mixer until light and fluffy.
- Sift the flour with the baking powder then add to the mixture in the bowl a little at a time along with the softened butter. Continue to mix until completely blended, then stir in the yogurt and the vanilla, if using.
- In a food processor, process the whole lemon until it is almost pureed.
- Add this lemon to the cake mixture and stir until evenly combined, then put the batter into the prepared tin.
- Bake for 50-60 minutes (depending on your oven), but test with a cake tester or skewer to make sure the whole lemon cake is done before removing from the oven. Allow to cool for about 15 minutes, then remove the side of the springform pan.
- Prepare the glaze by melting the sugar in the lemon juice and water, and allow to simmer for a few minutes, just until the liquid has a syrupy consistency. Spoon and brush over the top of the cake and allow to cool completely before cutting.
- Yes, it's hard to wait, but the moist lemon cake will cut more easily if it's cool first.
- Garnish with a twist of lemon or a few lemon slices, or just serve plain.